



IT'S ALL SMILES FOR NOW BUT YEDDYURAPPA (LEFT) HAS MUCH TO FEAR IN THE COMPANY OF JANARDHAN (CENTRE) AND SRIRAMULU

ment face briefing the media for the Reddys, vouched for Renukacharya.

Most of these MLAs who had joined the Reddy camp were upset that newcomers were bagging prime posts under Yeddyurappa at the cost of old timers. One legislator—Kogwad MLA Raju Kage—a close aide of Renukacharya, even taunted Yeddyurappa that if he showed up in front of the chief minister he would not be able to identify him. That rural development and panchayat raj minister Shoba Karandlaje hogged the limelight on flood relief work and during Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's Raichur visit and that Karunakara was not consulted by Yeddyurappa when the latter roped in businessman and Rajya

Sabha member Rajeev Chandrashekhara to head a private-public partnership project to relocate flood-hit villages in north Karnataka, only served as the last straw.

Even though the Reddys wanted Yeddyurappa's head, the Swaraj-brokered deal has given them Karandlaje's head instead. Even if there has to be another woman in the Cabinet to represent the gender, it will be from the Reddy camp. Speaker Jagadish Shettar, who was being primed to replace the chief minister, has to be content with a cabinet berth for now. He will soon be inducted while one of Yeddyurappa's men will replace him in the Speaker's seat.

Post the truce, Yeddyurappa has

said that he will convene a monthly meeting of BJP MLAs to elicit their views and include them in decision making. The chief minister says he will also change his style of leadership and will henceforth take his team along. With no say in the choice of selection of his new team, however, Yeddyurappa will only have his lifetime's desire to serve as the chief minister of Karnataka as the guiding force.

Although the 67-year-old former rice mill clerk's biggest USP is his strong RSS link and the organisation's backing, it may not have a big impact in Karnataka where it is important to bank on the state version of the RBI—Reddy Brothers Industry. But, with the RSS not backing the current crop of